

Feedback for Ethan Gould

FOCUS

- **PURPOSE and ARGUMENT:**

In your foreword, it is clear that your memo is focused towards proposing an AI-powered financial guidance platform for college students. In the problem statement it is more clear why this platform might be necessary for college students who do not know how to budget and need customized, cheap advice. One thing you can improve on is explaining why your generative AI integration is more useful than simply entering the information into an open source AI tool. Explain why it outweighs the current solution and why the feasibility of developing this platform is better for users in the long-term (probably will be solved when you complete the “Feasibility Analysis” section).

- **READER:**

It seems like you assume the reader knows how basic generative AI works in the backend since there isn't much technical description of the development process. It would be good to include an in-depth description of the basic technical needs of the project to explain why your development timeline is what it is to an authority who is not as well-versed in open AI. You also assume that the reader has a basic understanding of financial literacy issues. However, it would be useful to have a section outlining current budget planning applications and why each of them would fail in an example scenario to prove to the reader that college students would not benefit from anything but your platform.

- **ASSUMPTIONS:**

You make the main assumption that college students struggle with finances due to a lack of proper financial education and guidance. You also assume that AI tools are effective in solving the problem of creating a personalized financial budget and that college students trust AI to make a budget for them. These are all assumptions that are related to the problem and solution you are referring to, so I would not suggest changing anything regarding assumptions. However, you can convince the reader to accept your assumptions more by providing evidence of students benefiting from using AI for financial planning and explaining why AI is a trustworthy and secure resource to feed financial information to.

- **EVIDENCE:**

You include evidence, especially in the background information of the memo where you outline why financial illiteracy is a big problem. The evidence is persuasive because your sources are backed by data. You can add more supporting evidence to other sections such as the proposed solution section. Adding sources that would support your conceptualization and design of the platform would make the memo more persuasive.

- **LENGTH:**

The draft is a good length for the sections that are finished. When completing the other sections remember to not be redundant and separate the information in the “proposed solution” from the information in the “feasibility” section.

FORM

- **TITLE/SUBJECT:**

The memo needs a header with the memo format of “To” and “From.” Currently there is no subject line in the memo, but adding something like “Generative-AI Financial Guide for College Students” would be effective at reflecting the main argument of your memo.

- **FRONT MATTER:**

The summary is good and needs to be completed. The Problem statement is effective and can be extended on by adding the significance. The proposed solution sentence is good but you can remove the “via CSV uploads, manual entries, or linked bank accounts” and move that information to the section where you proposed the solution.

- **SECTION ORGANIZATION:**

The organization is good. The statement of the problem and the summary seem redundant as a reader. Try making the summary much shorter and leave the main information about the solution to the Statement of the Problem section. Move the potential impact section above the feasibility section to make it flow right after the project scope.

- **PACE:**

The pace is good but the background information vs. the problem scope are very different. You spend a lot of time on the background information with a plethora of details while the project scope is very high level. Adding more flowing sentences and evidence to the project scope will match the pace of these two sections.

- **SECTION LENGTH:**

The length of the background section is good. For the other sections, consider shortening the summary to one paragraph. Make the project scope less broken by compiling technical goals under one header and development timeline under another. Required features should be before additional features and should potentially be supported in sentence format with evidence.

VOICE

Paragraphs and sentences carry the style and tone of the draft. Read carefully line-by-line as you answer these questions.

- **IDEA PLACEMENT:**

The idea placement is good. The document presents the important ideas in the correct format but can use some editing in the sections where information is presented in list format. Transitions between background information and project scope would help the flow and adding more sentences would be better for readability.

- **PARAGRAPHS:**

Each paragraph that you have currently is good by can benefit from more sentences formatted with the same problem, topic, and evidence format from the lecture slides. The paragraphs that you have in the background information are good and you can use those for reference for the other sections.

- **SENTENCES:**

Add more sentences overall. Otherwise the sentences such as “College students often lack accessible, reliable, and affordable financial planning resources. Existing budgeting platforms either provide straightforward summaries without customized advice or are too expensive and time-consuming” are well drafted to provide an overview of the problem and are very specific. Continue using descriptive but concise sentences when redrafting your project scope.

- **WORDS:** Good. Some places such as “In addition, many of these existing solutions provide only a snapshot of someone’s current finances without offering actionable guidance” have unnecessary words. In other words, you can say “In addition, many of these existing solutions do not offer concrete financial guidance.” This would get the point across faster.
- **CULTURALLY APPROPRIATE USE:** Good.
- **SPELLING AND MECHANICS:** Good.